

Interview Guide



Welcome to your preparation guide for your interview at Meta! This guide will take you approximately 40 minutes to review. Use the table of contents below to quickly jump to the section you are looking for. Whether you’re taking your initial screen or your full round of interviews, our Software Engineering leaders and recruiters put together this guide so you know what to expect and how to prepare. We recognize that interviewing can be stressful, so we hope this guide provides the information and resources you need. Remember, your recruiter is there to support you, so please reach out to them with any questions.

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Accommodations process

Meta is committed to providing reasonable support (called accommodations) in our recruiting processes for qualified candidates with disabilities, physical conditions, mental health conditions, neurodivergence, sincerely held religious beliefs, pregnancy, childbirth, or related medical conditions,

as required by law. If you need assistance or require an accommodation, reach out via the [Accommodations request form](#).

Interview process overview

This guide will explain what to expect during your interviews with Meta. As part of your interview, you will have the opportunity to meet with peers, cross-functional partners, and other leaders at Meta. Your recruiter will be your guide throughout the process and aim to adequately prepare you to bring your best self to your interview.

What will your interview process be?

Your interview process will include 4-5 45-60 minute interviews; each interview will leave a few minutes at the end for your questions. You can expect the following interviews in the full loop round:

- Coding (1-2 interviews)
- Design (2 Interviews)
- Behavioral (1 interview)

Video Conference interview best practices

- Make sure you're in a quiet environment.
- Double check that you have a reliable internet/phone connection.
- It's okay to ask the person you're speaking with to speak slowly if you can't catch what they're saying.
- You'll need a laptop with a webcam, speaker, and mic. We recommend using a headset or headphones with a mic for better quality audio, but this is optional.
- While we embrace the usage of advanced tooling in our day-to-day work to build the future of social connection, we ask that you not use any unauthorized outside assistance during interviews. Throughout the interview process you may be asked to share your screen via Zoom. Here you can find [guidance](#) on how this works. Additionally, we ask that you disable and not use filters during your interview. This will help us get an understanding of how you approach problem-solving and coding independently. Outside assistance includes, but is not limited to, consulting external resources, seeking help from others, or using AI tools unless provided by Meta.
 - For your interview, ensure Zoom screen sharing is enabled in advance, as setup may require a few minutes. Here's how: [Enable Zoom screen share](#).

- A filter is considered any tool/feature that applies visual effects to your video feed, including virtual/blurred background.

Interview Dress Code

As you're probably aware, we promote a casual environment at Meta so that everyone can be their authentic selves. Formal dress is not required (jeans are definitely ok!). Dress comfortably. We care about what you can do, not what you wear.

AI-Native Coding Interviews

What can you expect?

The AI-Native Coding Interview is a 60-minute session that assesses your problem-solving, code development and understanding, verification and debugging, and technical communication skills. You will be expected to run/execute code and will use existing data files and/or codebases to work through a coding problem. Because of the format of the interview, this coding interview is only available to complete in certain coding languages. You can see what languages are currently available in the practice question that you can find in [Career Profile](#).

AI Assistant and IDE Capabilities

In the AI-Native Coding Interview, you will be working in a CoderPad environment that includes an AI assistant and code execution capabilities.

AI Assistant

The AI assistant tab allows you to ask the LLM questions. It has access to all the code shown in the editor, so you won't need to copy and paste your code into the text box.

It is **required** to use the AI assistant during the interview; however, your interviewers may provide some guidance on when to/not to use the LLM to be able to get the signal they need. It's important to remember that we cannot guarantee the accuracy of anything the LLM says. You will still need to understand the underlying code, which is necessary for progressing through the interview.

IDE (CoderPad) Capabilities

The CoderPad environment is a multi-file environment, allowing you to work with projects that are more relevant to daily engineering projects and tasks. Key features include:

- **File Directory Structure:** A directory tree layout on the left, showing multiple files.

- **Terminal Area:** A pane on the right where program output may appear.
- **Run Main/Run Tests Button:** A green button at the top of the pad to execute code.
- **Supported languages:** You can use Python, Java, Typescript, C++, C#, Kotlin, Swift, Rust, and Go.

What do we look for?

The AI-Native Coding Interview will assess your performance on the following five focus areas: Problem Solving, Code Development and Understanding, Verification and Debugging, Technical Communication, and AI Usage.

- **Problem Solving:** Are you able to clarify and refine problem statements? Can you generate solutions to open-ended and quantitative problems?
- **Code Development and Understanding:** Are you able to navigate a codebase to develop and build on working code structures and to evaluate the quality of produced code? Can you analyze and improve code quality and maintainability? Does code work as intended after it is executed?
- **Verification and Debugging:** Can you find and mitigate errors to ensure code runs / functions as intended? Are you able to verify solutions meet specified requirements, leveraging test / edge cases and handling errors and exceptions? How well do your unit tests run?
- **Technical Communication:** How well can you communicate reasoning, discuss technical ideas, ask thoughtful questions, and incorporate feedback?
- **AI Usage:** How do you use AI tools and effective prompts to aid in coding tasks? How do you evaluate AI output and implement it into code?

General guidance for the AI-Native Interview

- **Understand the Code:** While AI can generate code, it is crucial for you to understand the underlying code, whether pre-existing or AI-written.
- **Communicate Your Thought Process:** Just like in traditional coding interviews, vocalize your thought process as you work through the problem.
- **Managing AI Hallucinations:** Be aware that AI can hallucinate or lead you astray. Your interviewer will also help ensure that the AI doesn't drive the conversation too far in an unhelpful direction.
- **Unblocking Yourself:** Leverage the AI to unblock yourself if you get stuck on minor syntax issues or need to produce a large amount of code.

How to prepare

Interviewers can only assess your skills and abilities based on what you show them during your interview, so it's important to plan and prepare to best showcase your strengths. It is highly recommended to access the CoderPad practice environment prior to your interview to familiarize yourself with the new features. The link for this can be found in your [Career Profile](#).

- **Practice with Starter Code:** The ideal questions for this new type of interview may have some amount of starter code which you can understand before diving in.
- **Implement Real Code:** Be prepared to write and execute on real, implementable code.
- **Brainstorm Approaches:** Engage in critical thinking and brainstorming of approaches to solve the problem.
- **Verify Your Code:** Utilize unit tests or other methods to verify your code is working. Pre-written tests will often be provided to save you time.
- **One Question in One Hour:** AI-Enabled Interviews will be 60 minutes. Expect one thematic question with several parts (similar to a System Design interview). This gives you time to read and understand code, interact with the AI in an unfamiliar platform, and execute the program.
- **Multi-part Questions:** Questions will have parts, stages, or checkpoints. This allows candidates who don't lean into AI to have an achievable objective (first checkpoint or two), while AI power users might have several more.
- **Focus on Non-Coding Aspects:** Be prepared for non-coding parts to the question, such as runtime analysis, justifying tradeoffs, making contract changes, or reasoning about data. These areas are where AI is less powerful and where you can demonstrate deeper understanding.

Design Interview

What can you expect?

The design interview is a 45-minute interview and covers the design of complex systems or products and the trade-offs within your design. This will be a challenging and deeply technical discussion, and the scope of the question can vary widely. This System Design interview is focused on distributed systems, scalability, performance, and efficiency.

What do we look for?

The purpose of this interview is to assess your ability to solve a non-trivial engineering design problem. The interviewer is trying to determine if you can architect a solution to a higher-level problem that requires connecting multiple concepts. The question will be something very high-level and it will be up to you to drive the conversation.

Your interviewer will be thinking about how your skills and experience might help Meta as well as how you tackle problems you're not as familiar with. In your design interview, your interviewer will assess your performance on 4 focus areas:

- **Problem navigation:** Are you demonstrating your ability to organize the problem spaces, the constraints, and the potential solutions? You should be asking questions to reduce ambiguity, identify the most critical problems, understand what is needed for quantitative analysis, and define a requirement set to design to.
- **Solution design:** We are evaluating your ability to design a working solution that addresses either the complete problem/design or pieces of the problem/design. Are you able to consider the big picture in your design?
- **Technical excellence:** Can you dive into the technical details when needed? Can you identify and articulate the dependencies and trade-offs? How are you mitigating potential risks and failure points?
- **Technical communication:** Can you articulate your vision and technical ideas clearly? We are assessing your ability to communicate your reasoning as well as understand and address feedback from the interviewer.

How to prep

Interviewers can only assess your skills and abilities based on what you show them during your interview, so it's important to plan and prepare to best showcase your strengths. As you begin preparing, please reference your Career Profile for additional role-specific prep materials, if available.

This may be a challenging interview to prepare for given it is so interactive and there's no "right answer" for a design problem. Use the prep tips here and the resources listed in the appendix.

In addition to reviewing the above information, these tips may be helpful as you prepare:

- **Improve upon a design.** Think about and review the complex systems you've already designed. What would you change about your approach if you did it all over again? What worked well?
- **Design from the ground up.** Think about how you'd design a system that Meta (or another large tech company) already has. It's a good exercise to think through the complicated, high-scale systems that you already use every day. How would you design it from scratch? What are the bottlenecks to your solution? How would you address them?
- **Think through tradeoffs.** Avoid focusing on only optimal solutions. We're much more interested in seeing how you think through basic tradeoffs.
- **Do some research.** Read engineering blogs about approaches that have worked for big companies along the way. Read about the false-starts too!
- **Be holistic and detailed.** Practice moving effortlessly from high-level information to the precise

details. Outline the high-level requirements by describing what components you may need, how they fit together, and how to get to that solution.

- **Practice system design questions:** Find a few system design questions online and try to answer them on paper in roughly 30 minutes per question.

During the Interview

System Design

In the system design interview, we will expect you to demonstrate an understanding of the low-level constraints and how they affect the high-level goals. Be sure to talk through your solutions while keeping in mind different tradeoffs. Some areas to discuss in system design:

- **Testability:** formally, or otherwise, gaining confidence that the components are correct.
- **Usability:** customer's experience with the system or product and how to evolve it quickly.
- **Extensibility:** changing the software system over time.
- **Security:** can the system or product survive DDOS, spoofing, tampering, repudiation, etc.
- **Portability:** execution in different environments.
- **Availability:** how the system survives failures.
- **Scalability:** how the system can grow over time.
- **Operational characteristics:** diagnosing or debugging problems when they occur.

Example system design questions:

- Design a URL shortener
- Build a Facebook chat
- Architect a worldwide video distribution system

AI-Enabled Design Interview

What can you expect?

The AI-Enabled design interview is a 45-minute interview and focuses specifically on agentic/AI systems, including scalability, performance, efficiency, safety, iteration, and evaluation. This interview also adds an AI assistant to help with ideating, researching, and brainstorming. This is still a largely discussion-driven interview and you should not over-rely on using the AI assistant.

AI Assistant and IDE Capabilities

One design interview will be conducted in Excalidraw without AI assistance and the other will be conducted in CoderPad with Mermaid Markdown with the same AI assistant available in the coding interview, which will enable you to create initial design flows / visuals. You will also have access to CoderPad's "Draw" mode, which uses a version of Excalidraw. However, please note that CoderPad's AI Assist cannot process content created in "Draw" mode. For this reason, using Mermaid markdown is the preferred method.

We are evaluating the same skills in both types of design interviews (see below for more details). While an AI Assistant is provided to you in the System Design (with AI) interview, you must demonstrate your own understanding of the problem and proposed solution. You will not get credit for simply providing an AI-generated solution / explanation without adjusting, adding to, or editing it.

What do we look for?

The purpose of this interview is to assess your ability to solve a non-trivial agentic/AI-specific design problem. The interviewer will try to determine if you can architect a solution to a higher-level problem that requires connecting multiple concepts. The question will be high-level, and it will be up to you to drive the conversation.

Your interviewer will be thinking about how your skills and experience might help Meta, as well as how you tackle problems you're not as familiar with. In your design interview, your interviewer will assess your performance on 4 focus areas:

- **Problem navigation:** Are you demonstrating your ability to organize the problem spaces (both AI and non-AI components), the constraints, and the potential solutions? How are you applying judgment to weigh how to best integrate AI into the problem solving process? You should be asking questions to reduce ambiguity, identify the most critical problems, understand what is needed for quantitative analysis, and define a requirement set to design to.
- **Solution design:** We are evaluating your ability to design a working solution that addresses either the complete problem/design or pieces of the problem/design. Are you able to consider the big picture in your design? How are you using AI and automation, including considering safety, evaluation, and iteration of your agentic/AI solution?
- **Technical excellence:** Can you dive into the technical details (both AI and non-AI components) when needed? Can you identify and articulate the dependencies and trade-offs? How are you mitigating potential risks and failure points?
- **Technical communication:** Can you articulate your vision and technical ideas clearly? We are assessing your ability to communicate your reasoning as well as understand and address feedback from the interviewer.

How to prep

In addition to guidance to prepare for the classic system design interview, for the AI Native System Design Interview, you should:

- **Practice in CoderPad's AI-assisted environment:** Practicing for your AI-Native Coding interview will directly translate to this interview, as you'll be using the same AI Assist. You'll also have access to mermaid markdown and drawing mode in CoderPad. You can explore and practice in this environment in the link to a practice session that can be found in your [Career Profile](#).
- **Do NOT solely rely on AI:** For this interview, while the AI Assistant can be used to unblock you, you will not get credit for any answers the AI fully produces for you without making any adjustments or applying your own thinking to. You will need to demonstrate your own understanding / explanation of the problem and proposed solution above and beyond what the AI Assistant generates for you.

Behavioral Interview

What can you expect?

The behavioral interview will consist of a 45-minute session. Your interviewer will want to learn about your background, what you're passionate about in tech, and what kind of impact you want to make.

What do we look for?

Your interviewer will be thinking about how your skills and experience might help Meta as well as how you tackle problems you're not as familiar with. In your behavioral interview, your interviewer will assess your performance on 5 focus areas:

- **AI-Driven Impact:** How do you leverage AI to create measurable impact? How do you execute / drive forward work to achieve results? How do you safely and responsibly use AI to enhance problem solving?
- **Continuous AI Learning:** How do you seek out and build on opportunities for growth and learning both AI and non-AI technologies and concepts? How do you experiment and iterate with emerging technological capabilities and workflows? Do you take constructive criticism as an opportunity to improve? How have you approached improving your skills?
- **Partnering:** How do you drive collaboration on cross-functional projects? When faced with disagreements with colleagues and/or managers, how have you resolved them? How have you addressed conflicts directly and approached difficult conversations?
- **Embracing Ambiguity:** How do you operate in an ambiguous and quickly changing

environment? Are you comfortable making decisions and maintaining high levels of productivity when you are missing information or lack clarity? How did you react when you had to quickly pivot away from a project due to a shift in priority?

- **Communicating Effectively:** How well do you communicate with teams? What about cross-functional partners? How do you tailor your communications based on the work and/or the audience?

We may ask you to:

- Discuss available details of past and current projects
- Provide specific examples about what you did and the resulting impact.
- Share what you learned from a past situation.
- Talk about what you like about your current role and/or being a developer.

How to prep

Interviewers can only assess your skills and abilities based on what you show them during your interview, so it's important to plan and prepare to best showcase your strengths. As you begin preparing, please reference your Career Profile for additional role-specific prep materials, if available.

Just like with the coding and design interviews, it's important to prepare ahead of time for interviews designed to get to know you better. In addition to reviewing the above information, these tips may be helpful as you prepare:

- **Know yourself.** Take the time to review your own résumé as your interviewer will almost certainly ask about key events in your work history. Be prepared to discuss projects in depth. It's helpful to outline 2-3 major projects ahead of time.
- **Be honest.** Not every project is a runaway success, and we may not always interact perfectly with our peers. Being transparent in these situations won't be counted against you in the interview. In fact, sharing & discussing how you learned, improved, and grew from your past experiences is valued. Share what you learned from a past situation.
- **Use the S.T.A.R. method to mentally organize your thoughts.** This will provoke a well-thought-out and chronological action of events. Easy to describe, easy to follow. You can practice this method using the Journaling Exercises in the Preparation Hub within your Career Profile
 - S—One or two sentences about the SITUATION: What happened?
 - T—Describe the TASK: What was your specific goal?
 - A—ACTIONS you took to overcome the obstacles and complete your objective.

- R—The tangible / quantifiable RESULTS of the situation: How did it help 9 the team / company?
- **Have concrete examples or anecdotes.** Support each question with practical experiences and examples. Avoid theoretical answers - if you go into a theoretical tangent, your interviewer will redirect you to provide a concrete example.

Final tips for your interview

- **Be yourself.** This means being open and honest about your successes and ways you've improved throughout your career. Also, be sure to call out how you have specifically added value to your team or projects you've contributed to. We value teamwork and what each individual member brings to the table.
- **Carefully review and familiarize yourself with the job description and perform research on Meta and the role.** Be prepared to answer why you are interested in this specific role and in working at Meta.
- **Please take the time to review our [mission statement](#) and [core values](#).** These values influence how we work together to fulfill our mission to build the future of human connection and the technology that makes it possible. We also encourage you to take time using our technologies such as Facebook, Instagram, Messenger, and WhatsApp.
- **One important piece of advice for your interviews: it's ok if you don't know!** No one who works at Meta is an expert in all things, and we don't look for perfection in the people we interview. If you aren't sure of something during your interview, you're encouraged to ask clarifying questions and be upfront if there are topics that you have less experience with.
- **Prepare thoughtful questions for the interviewer(s).** Your interviewer may challenge your ideas, and you should be ready to speak not only to what you recommend or have experienced but the why as well. It is important to think outside the box and to approach problems from creative and different perspectives.
- **Focus on recent work / examples.** As you are answering questions in this interview, you should focus on recent examples for each question (examples that have occurred in the last 2-3 years).

Post interview – What to expect

You can expect your recruiter to provide a specific timeline or updates along the way. Your recruiter will

inform you of next steps after your interview as soon as they are available. Feel free to follow up with them if you have not heard within a week of your interviews.

Appendix / Resources

Below is a curated list of resources to get started and help you prepare.

Role-specific prep

- [Engineering at Meta - FB page](#)
- [Meta Code videos](#)
- [Meta Opensource website](#)
- [Engineering Leadership at Meta blog](#)

Coding Resources

- [Software Engineering Interview Q+A Video](#)
- Cracking the Meta Coding Interview Videos ([The Approach](#) and [Problem Walkthrough](#)) (password: FB_IPS)
- [Topcoder](#)
- [GeeksQuiz](#)

Design Interview Resources

- [System and Product Design Interview overview](#)
- [Grokking the Design Interview overview](#)
- [GitHub Design Primer](#)
- Familiarize yourself with [Excalidraw](#)

Meta resources

- [About Meta](#) website
- [Meta Newsroom](#) website
- [Meta Careers](#) website
- [Culture at Meta](#) website
- [Meta employee benefits](#) website
- [Interviewing at Meta: The keys to success](#) blog

Update personal information, track interview progress, and send thank you notes.

At any time during the interview process, you can track your progress, send thank-you notes and update your personal information all via the [Career Profile](#). If you do not receive a link from recruiting, you may create one.

Thank you for taking the time to review this guide!